

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | CrowdStrike | Microsoft Security | Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR)

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience implementing and maintaining robust security controls across enterprise infrastructure. In my current role I run day-to-day operations for a Microsoft-heavy estate serving more than 8,000 users, with deep expertise in CrowdStrike Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) tuning, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks, and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) or Extended Detection and Response (XDR) alert triage. I have led firewall administration, Web Application Firewall (WAF) and Distributed Denial of Service (DDoS) protection, email and web security gateways such as Mimecast, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and Single Sign-On (SSO) rollouts, Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) through Intune, vulnerability scanning and remediation, and full incident response aligned to National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK. I thrive in small, focused security teams operating in fast paced regulated environments and I am ready to bring the same rigour to a City of London financial brokerage on a hybrid basis.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Next Generation SIEM, Prevent, Insight, Discover; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Defender for M365
- **SIEM, SOAR and Detection Engineering:** CrowdStrike NG SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel, Splunk / Search Processing Language (SPL); Kusto Query Language (KQL); custom detections, use cases and automated response playbooks
- **Email and Web Security Gateways:** Mimecast (email security, targeted threat protection, secure messaging); Microsoft Defender for Office 365
- **Firewalls, Web Application Firewall (WAF) and DDoS:** Check Point Harmony, exposure to Palo Alto and Cisco firewall administration, Microsoft Gateways, WAF and DDoS controls
- **Identity, MFA and SSO:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Conditional Access, MFA, SSO, Group Policy; Duo and Okta concepts transferable from Entra ID Conditional Access design
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM; least privilege enforcement, session monitoring and secrets vaulting
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; remediation of penetration test findings and continuous vulnerability scanning; adaptable to Rapid7 InsightVM and InsightIDR
- **Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM):** Microsoft Intune, compliance policies, Autopilot and application protection
- **Incident Response:** National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) 800-61 lifecycle, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, forensic triage, containment and lessons learned
- **Automation and Scripting:** PowerShell, SOAR playbook development, Logic Apps concepts
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), Center for Internet Security (CIS) Controls, International Organization for Standardization (ISO) 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Operate as a senior member of a small, focused security team implementing and maintaining robust security controls across an infrastructure of more than 8,000 users, mirroring the small team model used in financial services security functions.

- Own day-to-day tuning, detection engineering and alert response across CrowdStrike Falcon EDR / XDR and CrowdStrike Next Generation SIEM, reducing false positives while improving mean time to detect and respond.
- Run alert triage and incident response across CrowdStrike, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft Sentinel; author Kusto Query Language (KQL) queries for threat hunting and forensic investigations.
- Administer Mimecast email security including anti phishing, targeted threat protection and Data Leak Prevention (DLP) policies for a large regulated user base.
- Manage MFA, SSO and Conditional Access in Azure Active Directory / Entra ID; design and enforce identity and access policies aligned to zero trust principles.
- Deliver vulnerability management using Pentra BAS, Tenable.io and AppCheck; remediate penetration test findings in partnership with infrastructure and application teams.
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) covering secrets vaulting, session monitoring and just in time access for privileged accounts.
- Deploy and maintain Intune for MDM and MAM, Check Point Harmony firewall policies and endpoint hardening baselines.
- Automate response actions via SOAR playbooks and PowerShell scripting; reduce manual analyst effort on repeatable incidents.
- Provide out of hours support for critical incidents and priority projects.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Delivered end to end deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Defender for Identity (MDI) across an 8,000 user estate, standing up detection rules, response actions and reporting.
- Configured and tuned Microsoft Sentinel workbooks, analytics rules and automation, integrating logs from Azure Active Directory, CrowdStrike, Mimecast and network infrastructure.
- Ran daily SIEM and EDR alert triage and threat hunting using KQL and Splunk Search Processing Language (SPL).
- Led vulnerability management operations using Tenable.io and AppCheck; prioritised remediation using Common Vulnerability Scoring System (CVSS) and business risk context.
- Managed Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO) and Conditional Access in Entra ID; supported IdP integrations equivalent in principle to Duo and Okta patterns.
- Contributed to incident response following NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK, producing post incident reports and control improvements.
- Supported delivery of Cyber Essentials Plus and internal ISO 27001 aligned controls.

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Supported production infrastructure for a Software as a Service platform used by global enterprise customers, providing exposure to a regulated data environment similar to financial services.
- Ran vulnerability scanning, patching and endpoint hardening across cloud and on premise systems.
- Assisted with firewall and web gateway administration, MFA rollout and endpoint security tooling.
- Contributed to incident triage and remediation of security tickets in coordination with Development Operations (DevOps) and engineering teams.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Delivered Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Defender for Identity (MDI) rollout to more than 8,000 users, providing enterprise wide visibility and reducing dwell time on endpoint threats.
- Built and tuned CrowdStrike Falcon detections and response workflows, cutting false positives and shortening mean time to respond on high priority alerts.
- Automated repeatable incident response actions using SOAR playbooks and PowerShell, freeing analyst time for proactive threat hunting.
- Remediated critical penetration test and Breach and Attack Simulation findings, driving measurable reductions in exploitable exposure.

- Standardised Conditional Access, MFA and privileged access controls, strengthening identity assurance across the enterprise.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)